

2.5 Topic 3: Unequal Spaces

Rural and urban inequality

Movements of people, money and changing opportunities affect all parts of the rural-urban continuum. Whilst some areas flourish, others struggle and inequalities develop at a variety of scales – even between neighbouring people and groups. This topic explores the social, political and economic causes of disparities and identifies the 'haves and have-nots'. It then focuses on a more detailed evaluation of a range of strategies which have been designed to remove or manage inequalities, in the countryside, towns and cities.

Fieldwork and research opportunities

Fieldwork opportunities include local environmental and housing quality surveys, investigating disparity of crime/vandalism, access to services and mobility (especially in rural areas, eg emergency services, travel, shopping and education). Investigations might examine the causes of inequality, using surveys, questionnaires or oral histories, or evaluate the impacts of schemes and projects trying to tackle inequality. Opportunities for **research work** could make use of census data to show the pattern of disparity/inequality of opportunity. It could also involve use of Landsat, planning documents, maps and statistics (eg crime or service provision), evaluating decline or improvement over time. Rural work could involve applying a modern day Cloke's index.

1 Recognising inequality

Enquiry question: *What are unequal spaces and what causes them?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ The idea of inequality at a variety of scales and in contrasting areas.	■ Developing an awareness of inequalities in different areas.
■ The processes that lead to uneven levels of environmental quality, social opportunity, wealth (and poverty) and quality of life.	■ Researching the processes that create differing levels of inequality in people's lives.
■ Fieldwork and research , to explore the pattern of spatial inequality in one rural and one urban area using primary surveys and secondary data.	■ Using primary and secondary sources to investigate patterns of spatial inequality such as land use, environmental quality, accessibility/mobility, zones of exclusion together with census data, employment figures, planning documents, and old maps and photographs.

2 Inequality for whom?

Enquiry question: *What impact do unequal spaces have on people?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Inequality can lead to social and economic exclusion and polarisation, by denying opportunities and access to services in urban and rural areas.	■ Investigating the impacts of reduced opportunities and facilities in rural and urban areas such as in deprived areas of inner cities, peripheral estates, shanty towns, and contrasting remote rural areas.
■ How inequality creates marginalised groups in a variety of ways in rural and urban areas.	■ Becoming aware of how we can all experience the effects of inequality by gender, age, race and religion, employment, education, income, health and disability.

■ Fieldwork and research into inequality can help to: ◆ produce criteria to identify the spatial pattern of the 'haves' and 'have-nots' in rural and urban areas ◆ design a checklist to evaluate schemes to tackle inequality.	■ Using primary and complementary secondary (statistics and census) information to: ◆ investigate spatial patterns of inequality using evidence of deprivation based on ideas above, eg poverty, housing, quality of life, segregation ◆ audit could be based on 'outputs' such as jobs created, new business start-ups, etc and 'outcomes' like changes in socio-economic or physical conditions.
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3 Managing rural inequalities

Enquiry question: *How can we manage rural inequality and improve the lives of the rural poor? How successful have particular schemes been?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ There are serious social, economic and environmental problems and barriers creating rural inequality that need to be overcome.	■ Examining the main problems and barriers to equality including lack of access to affordable housing, local employment and basic services.
■ Fieldwork and research into the success of specific examples of ways to reduce rural inequalities using contrasting solutions such as: ◆ appropriate technology ◆ community involvement and empowerment ◆ improving access to transport and services ◆ local employment ◆ sustainable solutions.	■ Using primary (eg including video and audio evidence, survey of functions/employment) and secondary sources to investigate the success of named rural schemes involving for example: ◆ broadband access, reliable water supplies ◆ help for women, co-operatives, self-help groups ◆ dial a bus, mobile services, deliveries, post offices in pubs ◆ farming for environmental protection, diversification

4 Managing urban inequalities

Enquiry question: *What strategies can be used to combat inequality in urban areas? How successful have particular schemes been?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ There are social, economic and environmental problems associated with urban inequalities and key players are involved in delivering solutions.	■ Developing awareness of the problems associated with urban inequality and the key players such as international agencies, charities, governments, local and regional authorities, groups and individuals.
■ Fieldwork and research into the success of specific examples of ways to reduce urban inequalities using contrasting solutions such as: ◆ self-help schemes ◆ traffic and public transport ◆ town planning initiatives ◆ business initiatives ◆ crime and policing.	■ Using primary and secondary resources to investigate the success of named urban schemes involving for example: ◆ shanty builds, residents associations, neighbourhood watch ◆ congestion charging, park and ride, Oystercards ◆ sustainable communities, WHO Urban Healthy Planning Initiative ◆ minimum wage, furniture schemes, targeted recruitment from particular communities ◆ video surveillance, neighbourhood policing.